The Test series was followed by a one-day tri-series, with Zimbabwe as the third team. Our first match was against Australia at Kochi on 1 April, and it remains a match I have extremely fond memories of. I was opening the batting again in one-day cricket by this stage but unfortunately got out early. Luckily it did not matter, with Ajay Jadeja batting well in the middle order for a hundred and taking us past 300.

Australia got off to a flier. Adam Gilchrist, the best wicketkeeper-batsman of our generation, went after the bowling and they cruised to 100 in just twelve overs. It was apparent that if they played out the full fifty overs they'd win the game. Midway through the innings, I was brought on to bowl and I started bowling off-spin to the left-handers and leg-spin to the right-handers.

It's one of those strange things, but for some reason sometimes a batsman just does not like the sight of a particular bowler. In my case, I was never comfortable facing Hansie Cronje, who got me out on a number of occasions with his medium pace. Even when I was in control against the likes of Allan Donald, Hansie would somehow get the better of me and I'd get out to him in the most unexpected ways. So you don't always need to be a front-line bowler to trouble a particular batsman – and that's what happened between me and Steve Waugh. Throughout my career I had a feeling Steve wasn't comfortable against my leg-spin. At Kochi, I bowled a perfect leg-spinner to him and he lobbed the ball straight back to me.

I was elated at the dismissal and it was a big moment in the game. It was the opening we needed to put the pressure back on the Australians. The other big wicket that gave me a lot of satisfaction was that of Michael Bevan, a very effective batsman in limited-overs cricket, who was constantly trying to come down the wicket to negate the turn. I had warned Nayan Mongia, our wicketkeeper, that I'd bowl a quick one down the leg side if I saw Bevan try that against me. The ploy worked and Bevan was stumped off a wide ball down the leg side.

This was one of those rare matches when every ball was coming out of the hand perfectly, and I even had a fielder at slip past the thirty-over mark. The odd thing is that over the course of my career I found that whenever I practised hard at bowling leg-spin, I could never land the ball properly. And yet sometimes when I hadn't practised for months it just landed on the spot at crucial times in a match. In the end I decided to bowl leg-spin in the nets as and when I felt like it, without thinking too